

**SIMATS ENGINEERING
ASSESSMENT TOOL 2**

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COURSE NAME: COMPUTER NETWORKS
COURSE CODE: CSA07

COURSE OUTCOME COVERED

CO4:

Design network topologies star, mesh, bus, and hybrid using networking devices, transmission media, and cabling standards
(BL2.BL6)

Assessment Tool Weightage: 30%

Annexure A

Industry Problem-Solving Task

1. A star topology is ideal for a 20-person startup because all devices connect to a central switch, making the network easy to manage and troubleshoot. At the core sits a Layer 2/Layer 3 managed switch (such as a Cisco Catalyst or Netgear ProSafe) with at least 24 ports to accommodate all workstations, printers, and VoIP phones with room to grow. Each device connects to the switch using Cat6 UTP cables, which support Gigabit speeds up to 100 meters — more than sufficient for any typical office floor plan. The switch uplinks to a router/firewall (such as a Cisco RV series or pfSense appliance) that handles internet access, DHCP, and network address translation. A Wi-Fi access point connected to the switch extends wireless coverage for laptops and mobile devices.